

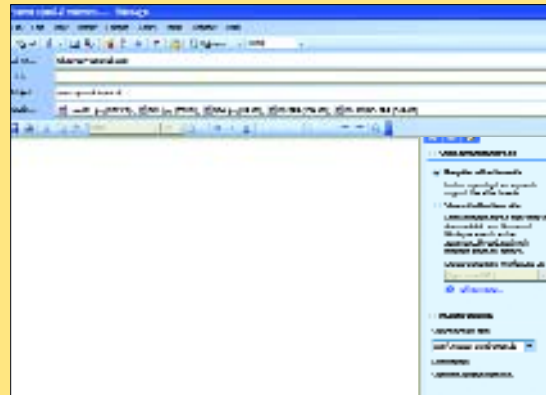
Taking pictures—from clicking to sharing

With both a film-based and a digital camera in possession, I decided to find out which was better when it came to clicking and sharing photos. The old way entailed prints and post offices; the tech way promised a digitised solution through-and-through.

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Mailing the pictures, the old way...



...e-mail beats snail mail any day

1

I picked up my old Kodak KZ25. It was out of film and I had to walk down to my nearest photo studio to buy a roll. Since the batteries had enough juice to last that one roll, I decided not to invest in a new set of alkaline batteries.

Time taken **15 minutes**

At 5 megapixels with 10X optical zoom, my Kodak DX6490 is a beauty. I ascertained that the batteries were usable. Preliminary check done, I headed to the menu to set the basic parameters to suit an indoor environment. I took a few sample snaps to double-check the results of the tweaking, and got ready for final shoot.

Time taken **30 minutes**

2

After clicking about 20 frames, I handed in the roll for development. Of course, I had to wait until the next evening to get the prints—a wait of 24 hours. The guy did offer express delivery, but that would have entailed additional cost. Cost for 20 copies, each of them 5 x 7 inches, around Rs 120.

Time taken **24 hours**

Using the onboard LCD, I was clicking and reviewing images with ease. I would click, decide whether or not to keep the picture, and click some more.

Time taken **20 minutes**

3

I chose five prints I wanted to share with my relatives by snail-mailing them. I put them all in an envelope, wrote out the address (which did not involve an '@' sign!) and sealed it. A drive to the local post office took around 15 minutes in Mumbai traffic. Five minutes in a queue for my turn. Stamps: Rs 8. Sticking them on and dropping the envelope into a postbox took another 5 minutes. Phew!

Time taken **25 minutes**

I plugged the camera to my PC and transferred my pictures to my hard drive. Then, I launched photo-editing software to do some post-processing and image scaling, to get them to a size suitable for e-mail.

Time taken **15 minutes**

4

It took four days for the prints to reach my relatives in Rajasthan! God bless the postal service.

Time taken **4 days**

After the images were trimmed to size, I started up my favourite e-mail client and attached them. An e-mail id later, the mail was off to my relatives.

Total Time Spent: **Five days, 40 minutes**
Total cost: **Rs 230**



Total Time Spent: **65 minutes**
Total cost: **Rs 0**



**AND
THE
WINNER
IS...**

My relatives received the images taken with the digital camera within a few minutes. What's more, I got a reply e-mail just as quick—all this was done in under an hour and a half. On the other

hand, the Old Way was much too time consuming and tedious. It's high time everyone who loves to share their favourite moments upgrade to a digital camera.